



Would you rather: a world with no social media, or a world with no AI? Why?

CAUSE AND EFFECT ESSAYS

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What it is?

Explores and Explains the relationship
between one event (cause) leads to
another event (an effect)

Cause & Effect Essays

01

INFORMATIVE

02

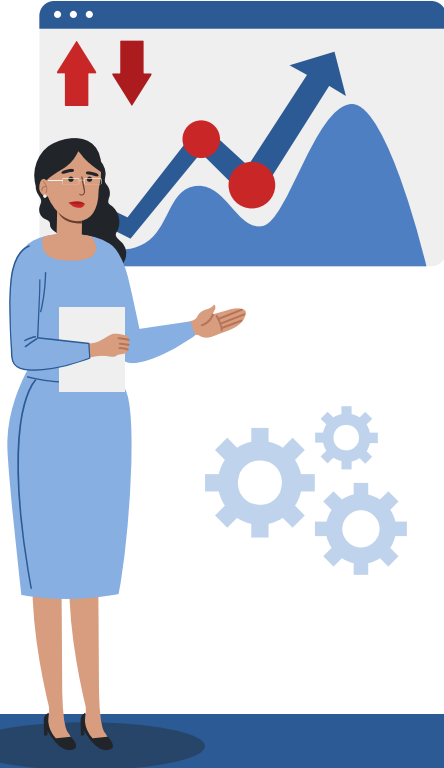
ANALYTICAL

03

INSIGHTFUL

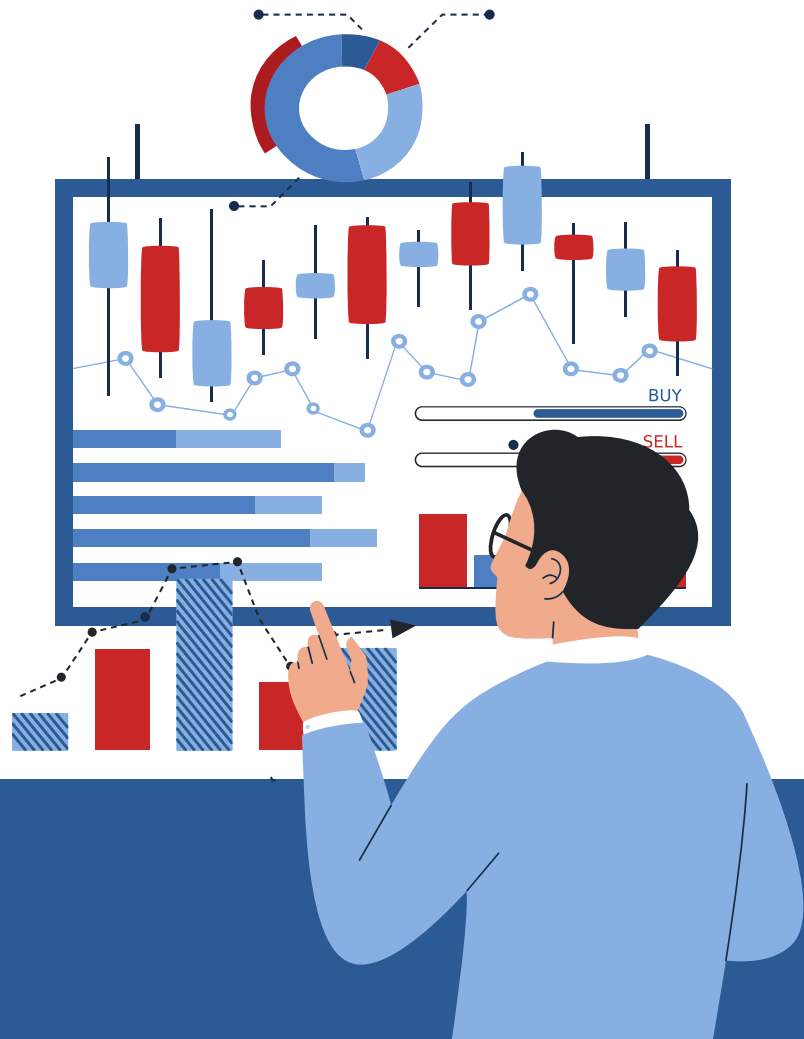
04

CRITICAL





CLASS ACTIVITY





1. What is the main purpose of this essay? Begin with *The purpose is...*

2. What is the thesis statement? _____

3. What kind of hook does the writer use in this essay? Circle the best answer.

question

interesting observation

scenario

quote

other

4. Reread the introduction. Between the hook and the thesis statement, the writer uses connecting information. Write that sentence or sentences here.

5. In Paragraph 4, the idiom *a white lie* is used in the topic sentence but is not defined. Write your own definition of a white lie. _____



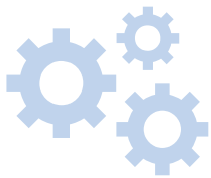
- 6.** In Paragraph 5, the author supports the topic sentence by giving an example of a dangerous situation. What example does the author give?

- 7.** In the space below, write your own concluding sentence.



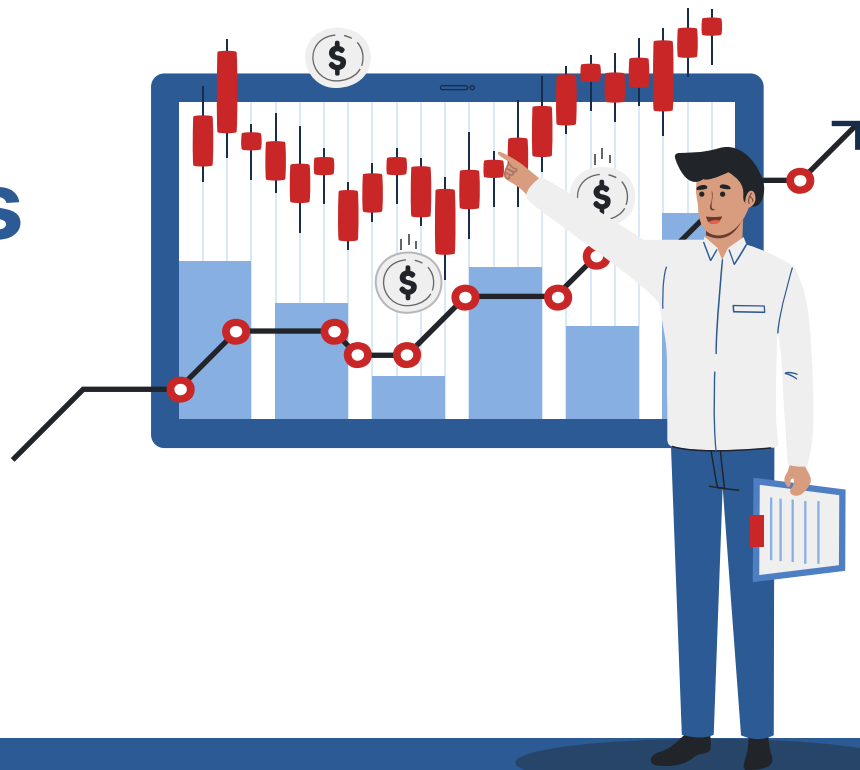
01

PATTERN OF DEVELOPMENT



Focus-on- Effects

Answers the question:
'What happens when or if...?'



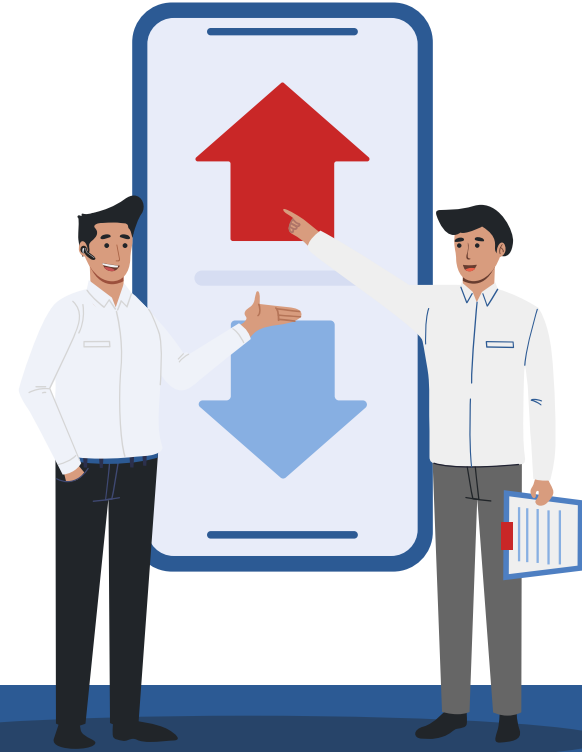
- In a **focus-on-effects essay**, you would write about the threatened habitat of polar bears as a result of global warming and the melting of large parts of the Arctic Circle. Your essay might include five paragraphs and look like this:

INTRODUCTION	Paragraph 1	Hook Connecting information Thesis
BODY	Paragraph 2	Effect 1: dangerous swimming conditions • sea ice platforms farther apart
	Paragraph 3	Effect 2: scarcity of food • fewer hunting opportunities
	Paragraph 4	Effect 3: reduced population • Females with less body weight have lower reproduction rates.
CONCLUSION	Paragraph 5	Restated thesis Suggestion/opinion/prediction

Imagine you had to write an essay on how AI affects critical thinking. Which three effect would you put at the center of your argument, and why would that be the most convincing case to make?



Activity



1. What is the main purpose of this essay? Begin with *The purpose is...*

2. Reread the thesis statement. Is it direct or indirect? _____

3. Write the topic sentence of each body paragraph. For each, circle the word(s) that tell you what the paragraph will focus on.

Paragraph 2: _____

Paragraph 3: _____

Paragraph 4: _____



4. In Paragraph 2, the writer explains that high blood pressure is a negative effect of insomnia. What evidence does the writer give to show the dangers of high blood pressure?

5. Read the following sentence: *Daily or even weekly exercise would lessen the chance of heart problems.* In which paragraph does this sentence belong? _____

6. Read the conclusion. Which sentence restates the thesis? Write it here.

Focus-on-Causes

Answers the question:
'Why does something happen?'



- In a **focus-on-causes essay**, you would write about the causes of global warming, such as excessive carbon dioxide in the atmosphere. In this case, the organization for this essay could have five paragraphs and look like this:

INTRODUCTION	Paragraph 1	Hook Connecting information Thesis
BODY	Paragraph 2	Cause 1: human activities • carbon dioxide from vehicles • not recycling (requires creating more products from scratch)
	Paragraph 3	Cause 2: increased industrial activity • greater carbon dioxide from burning fuels to run factories
	Paragraph 4	Cause 3: deforestation • Increased human population requires more space, so trees are cut down. • Fewer trees mean less oxygen, which causes a higher percentage of carbon dioxide in the atmosphere.
CONCLUSION	Paragraph 5	Restated thesis Suggestion/opinion/prediction

Focus on Causes	Focus on Effects
the causes of the high divorce rate in some countries	the effects of pollution in my country
the causes of World War I	the effects of high salaries for athletes
the causes of low voter participation in elections	the effects of the Internet on how businesses are run
the reasons new teachers quit	the impact of technology on education
why only a small percentage of people read newspapers today	what happens when a large percentage of adults cannot read well



ACTIVITIES

